

City Council July 6, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MXIKvHp2x9U
Publication Date	2026-07-07T02:46:27Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting Date: July 6, 2026

Body: Muncie Common Council

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** [00:00:02](#) Tax Abatement Committee Meeting. Focus: Review of a 5-year tax abatement request by Astimo Indiana, Inc. for \$9.4 million in new manufacturing equipment at 4400 North Superior Drive.
- **Summary of Discussion:** Tracy Leton (Economic Development Alliance) and Kevin Mohern (Astimo Site Lead) presented the project, noting it involves 188 retained jobs, 9 new jobs, and phased deductions. Committee members asked questions regarding wage ranges, local labor usage for building expansions, and compliance. The committee voted to issue a favorable recommendation to the full council.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** [00:28:27](#) Presiding officer President Green called the regular meeting to order following the statutory public meeting.
- **Attendance:**

- *Members Present:* Council President Green, Council Members Dishman, Macintosh, Mason, Basham, Sylvie, Galian, and one additional council member. (*Note: One member was noted as absent during voting discussions*).
 - *Presiding Officer:* Council President Green.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - **00:28:39** Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
 - **00:29:09** Opening invocation delivered by a member of the clergy.
 - **00:34:03** Citizen Recognition: Howard Miller, owner of Unks Barbecue (located at 1315 East Hines), was honored as the July Citizen of the Month for his community contributions and barbecue business.
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - **00:36:10** Councilman Basham noted misspellings of Mrs. Vach's name in the prior minutes.
 - **00:37:29** The amendment and subsequent adoption of the minutes as amended were approved by voice vote.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **03:02:56 Resolution 10-26: Additional Appropriation Resolution Relating to Fire Station Number Five Project**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented by legal counsel/administration representatives.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion centered on the financing structure, debt limits, and lack of administrative presence at prior committee meetings.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Christopher Bilbury and Todd Smeckkins raised concerns regarding Muncie's total debt load and borrowing limits.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by voice vote to send back to the Public Services Committee.
- **03:02:56 Resolution 11-26: Authorizing Entry into a Lease Agreement for Fire Station Number Five Project**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented by legal counsel.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Covered procurement and lease-financing mechanisms for the fire station project.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Comments from residents questioned the long-term cost and necessity of proceeding without finalized figures from prior fire station builds.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by voice vote to send to the Public Services Committee.

- **01:02:02 Ordinance 9-26 / 02:25:27 Resolution 9-26:** Assessment Value Deduction for Astimo Indiana, Inc.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tracy Leton & Kevin Mohern (Astimo).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal for a 5-year tax abatement for \$9.4 million in new manufacturing equipment (injection molding, vibration welding, intake manifold assembly). Retains 188 jobs and adds 9 new positions.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None specific to this item outside of committee.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
 - **01:06:01 Ordinance 10-26:** Additional Appropriation (Muncie Police Department)
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Housekeeping ordinance correcting an error where Gateway Fund items for police/fire were kicked out. An amendment was adopted changing references from "Muncie Fire Department" to "Muncie Police Department."
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote (as amended).
 - **01:09:31 Ordinance 11-26:** Additional Appropriation (Muncie Fire Department)
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
 - **01:10:22 Ordinance 12-26:** Comprehensive Zoning Amendment from R2 Residence Zone to BV Variety Business Zone at 4,600 North Wheeling Avenue.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
 - **01:20:07 Ordinance 13-26:** Text Amendment for New McKinley Neighborhood Overlay District
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kylene Swackhammer (Planning Commission), Rebecca Hannah, Phil Tevis, Joe Robertson, Bill Inman, and Bruce Recctor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Establishment of an overlay district combining master planning goals, design standards, parking reduction rules, and a neighborhood review committee. Overwhelming neighborhood and mayoral support.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Christopher Bilbury spoke in favor, urging the council to suspend rules and pass it immediately.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Rules suspended; Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote for final adoption.
 - **01:48:52 Ordinance 14-26:** Prohibiting Department Heads from Serving on Certain Boards and Commissions / Establishing Conflict of Interest Standards
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Introduced by Councilman Mason.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Lengthy debate regarding blanket bans, exclusions for certain employees, and the impact on city administration and human rights board participation. Multiple amendments were proposed and voted upon.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Wayne Scaife and Rob Miller spoke regarding the ethics, enforcement timing, and independence of citizen boards.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Retained for introduction/further review.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **03:38:47 Jacob Cool (Representative, ArkMuncie):** Spoke regarding Senate Bill 285 (homeless camping ban), highlighting local outreach efforts, resource gaps for unhoused individuals, and the search for a property partnership.
- **03:42:58 Nate Burgess (AFSCME Union President):** Addressed the council regarding stalled wage negotiations with the administration, expressing frustration over proposed pay offers and urging the council to hold the administration accountable.
- **03:46:22 Lynn Thornberg:** Spoke in support of ArkMuncie and the unhoused population, emphasizing personal struggles and the need for compassion.
- **03:47:48 Wayne Scaife:** Addressed the community center location dispute (Industry Neighborhood vs. alternate sites) and criticized ongoing labor contract issues.
- **03:51:57 Rob Miller:** Questioned council voting procedures and consistency.
- **03:53:05 Judith Hill:** Spoke regarding historical funding for the Industry neighborhood center and past multi-service facility history.
- **03:56:41 Cassandra Woods:** Shared historical perspective on the Industry neighborhood, growing up in Muncie Homes, and the vital role community centers play.
- **04:00:21 Audi Barber:** Criticized council oversight of the executive branch, lack of preparation, and communication issues.
- **04:03:13 Melvin Kelly (Executive Director, Brothers to Brothers):** Called for unity and collaborative problem-solving among community leaders regarding youth centers and neighborhood resources.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **00:59:31** Ethics Commission announced a public meeting for Wednesday, July 8th, at 5:30 PM at the Sanitary District conference room.
 - **01:08:11** Legal Counsel announced his departure; Brandon Murphy was nominated and approved as the new council legal counsel.
 - **03:19:43** Planning Commission (American Structure Point representatives) announced the kickoff of the comprehensive Unified Development Ordinance (UDO) rewrite project spanning city and county.
- **Adjournment:** **04:04:24** Motion to adjourn approved by voice vote.